HARE KRISHNA GOLDEN TEMPLE
BANJARA HILLS

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

PREMIUM PILGRIMAGE · MARCH 2027

Vaishno Devi
& Kashmir Pilgrimage

with ISKCON Hare Krishna Devotees







13 – 20 March 2027

7 Nights / 8 Days

Jammu · Katra · Vaishno Devi · Srinagar · Gulmarg · Sonamarg · Pahalgam

Registrations close 25 December 2026 · limited helicopter seats

Helicopter darshan | Night at Bhawan | Flight to Srinagar | Gulmarg · Sonamarg · Pahalgam | Sattvic food

Book Now →

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www.punyakshetras.com
www.hkmhyderabad.org

Warm greetings *from Punya Kshetras*

Begin with the temples of Jammu and Mother Vaishno Devi's darshan by helicopter, with a night at Bhawan for both Aartis. Then fly into the Kashmir valley, the land of Kheer Bhawani, Shankaracharya and Martand, where Gulmarg's snow, Sonamarg's glaciers and Pahalgam's valleys complete a pilgrimage that is as devotional as it is beautiful, in the association of ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees.

Punya Kshetras is the pilgrimage service of Hare Krishna Golden Temple, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad. Every yatra is led by devotees, with kirtan, japa and the glories of each holy place narrated along the way, sattvic food, careful planning and special attention to elders.



His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Srila Prabhupada,
Founder-Acharya of ISKCON

> *The holy places all over the earth are meant for purifying the polluted consciousness of the human being by an atmosphere surcharged with the presence of the Lord's unalloyed devotees. If anyone visits a holy place, he must search out the pure devotees residing in such holy places, take lessons from them, try to apply such instructions in practical life and thus gradually prepare oneself for moksha.*
>
> Srila Prabhupada · Srimad Bhagavatam 1.13.10, Purport

YATRA HIGHLIGHTS

- ★ Jammu temple circuit
- ★ Helicopter darshan of Shri Mata Vaishno Devi
- ★ Night at Bhawan with Evening & Morning Aarti
- ★ Bhairon Baba Temple by ropeway
- ★ Banganga & Darshani Deodi
- ★ Shikara ride on Dal Lake
- ★ Maharani Temple and gondola, Gulmarg
- ★ Kheer Bhawani Temple, Tulmulla
- ★ Martand Sun Temple & Avantipur ruins
- ★ Shankaracharya & Jyeshta Devi temples
- ★ Gulmarg, Sonamarg & Pahalgam excursions
- ★ Amalaki Ekadashi observed together on 17 March

OVERNIGHT STAYS

1 Night JAMMU	1 Night BHAWAN	1 Night KATRA
2 Nights SRINAGAR	1 Night GULMARG	1 Night PAHALGAM

YOUR DEPARTURE

Mid-March brings pleasant weather in Jammu and late-winter snow in Kashmir: carry warm layers for Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam, where nights are near freezing.

The route *step by step*

8	7	2	643	15
DAYS	NIGHTS	HELICOPTER RIDES	KM BY ROAD	TEMPLES & SHRINES

1 Jammu
Arrival · temple circuit

CAR 50 km

2 Katra
RFID · helipad

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

3 Bhawan
Darshan · Aarti · night

ROPEWAY 3 min

4 Bhairon
Completes the yatra

HELICOPTER 5–8 min

5 Katra
Banganga · night stay

CAR + FLIGHT 50 km · 50 min

6 Srinagar
Shankaracharya · Jyeshta Devi · shikara

continues → **Car** 52 km

7 Gulmarg
Gondola · Maharani Temple

CAR 130 km

8 Kheer Bhawani
Sonamarg excursion

CAR 82 km

9 Srinagar
Night stay

CAR 105 km

10 Pahalgam
Martand · Avantipur · valleys

CAR 100 km

11 Pampore → Srinagar Airport
Saffron · departure after 2 pm

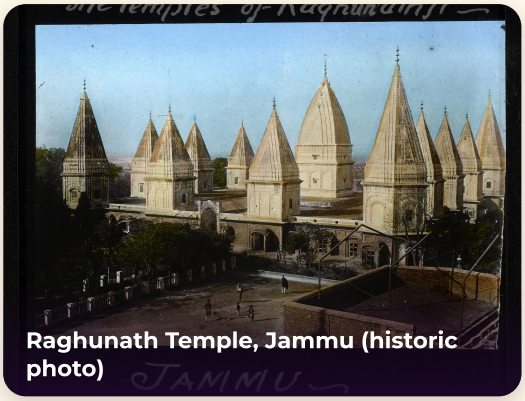

Helicopter to Sanjichhat


Gulmarg Gondola


Betaab Valley, Pahalgam



Bahu Fort, Jammu



Raghunath Temple, Jammu (historic photo)

DAY 01
Sat 13 Mar

Jammu Arrival – Temple Circuit

Overnight: **Jammu**

Arrive at Jammu, the City of Temples, by 2 pm. After check-in and a late lunch at the hotel, begin an evening circuit of its most revered shrines: Sri Raghunath Temple, Ranbireshwar Temple, the Mahakali shrine of Bawe Wali Mata inside Bahu Fort, and the Peer Kho cave temple on the banks of the Tawi, ending with its evening aarti.

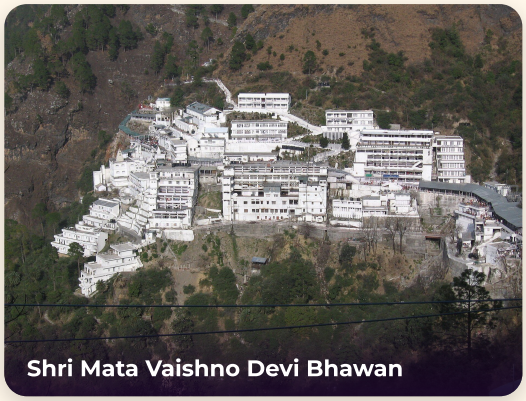
DID YOU KNOW?

Raghunath Temple, begun by Maharaja Gulab Singh in 1835 and completed by Maharaja Ranbir Singh in 1860, is dedicated to Lord Rama and houses a large collection of saligrama shilas. Ranbireshwar Temple is known for its tall Shiva lingam and twelve crystal lingams.

08:00 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**On own – at home / origin airport / in flight** · Breakfast on own before or during travel to Jammu (not included); carry a light snack, lunch is at 15:15	
14:00 – 14:30	ARRIVAL	**Jammu Airport (IXJ) / Jammu Tawi Rly Stn** · Meet representative, garland welcome, load luggage, headcount	
14:30 – 14:50	CAR	**Jammu Airport → Hotel, Jammu (Residency Rd area)** · Transfer to hotel (from Jammu Tawi station: ~4 km, 15 min)	7 km
14:50 – 15:15	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-in, freshen up	
15:15 – 15:50	LUNCH	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Late lunch – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg thali served on arrival; group pays	
15:50 – 16:05	CAR	**Hotel, Jammu → Raghunath Temple** · Drive to old-city temple complex	5 km
16:05 – 16:45	DARSHAN	**Raghunath Temple** · Darshan of Sri Rama, Sita and Lakshmana; galleries of saligramas; group kirtan	
16:45 – 16:55	CAR	**Raghunath Temple → Ranbireshwar Temple** · Short hop (can also walk ~10 min)	1 km
16:55 – 17:20	DARSHAN	**Ranbireshwar Temple** · Darshan of the 7.5 ft Shiva lingam and crystal lingams	
17:20 – 17:40	CAR	**Ranbireshwar Temple → Bahu Fort (Bawe Wali Mata)** · Cross the Tawi to Bahu Fort	6 km
17:40 – 18:30	DARSHAN	**Bawe Wali Mata Temple & Bahu Fort** · Darshan of Mahakali (Bawe Wali Mata); fort ramparts and Bagh-e-Bahu gardens at sunset	
18:30 – 18:55	CAR	**Bahu Fort → Peer Kho Cave Temple** · Drive along Circular Road	7 km
18:55 – 19:30	DARSHAN	**Peer Kho Cave Temple** · Cave shrine of the self-manifest Shiva lingam (Jambavan cave); evening aarti	
19:30 – 19:50	CAR	**Peer Kho Cave Temple → Hotel, Jammu** · Return to hotel	6 km
19:50 – 20:15	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Freshen up; Day 2 briefing (ID proofs, light bag for Bhawan, 06:30 breakfast)	
20:15 – 21:15	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays (not in room rate)	

Saturday 13 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Sanjichhat Helipad


Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Bhawan

DAY 02
Sun 14 Mar

Katra – Helicopter to Vaishno Devi Bhawan

Overnight: **Bhawan**

Drive to Katra at the foot of the Trikuta mountain, collect your RFID Yatra card and board the helicopter to Sanjichhat. A 2.5 km walk, pony or battery-car ride brings you to Bhawan. After rest and kirtan, enter the Holy Cave for darshan of the three Pindis and attend the Evening Aarti.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

In the Holy Cave the Mother is worshipped in the form of three natural rock Pindis, representing Maha Kali, Maha Lakshmi and Maha Saraswati. The shrine sits at about 5,200 ft on the Trikuta mountain.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Jammu** · Check-out, load luggage	
09:00 – 10:30	CAR	**Hotel, Jammu → Katra** · Drive via Jammu–Katra highway (NH144 / Nagrota); 10-min tea stop en route	50 km
10:30 – 11:00	REGISTRATION	**Yatra Registration Counter, Katra** · Collect RFID Yatra cards for every yatri (carry original photo ID)	
11:00 – 11:10	CAR	**Katra town → Katra Helipad** · Drive to helipad; main luggage stays in car / Katra hotel	2 km
11:10 – 12:15	REPORTING	**Katra Helipad** · Report per allotted slot (typically 1–2 hrs before), ticket & ID check, baggage weighing, security	
12:15 – 12:25	HELICOPTER	**Katra Helipad → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Flight approx. 5–8 min (about 5 km aerial)	
12:25 – 13:30	WALK / PONY / BATTERY CAR	**Sanjichhat Helipad → Bhawan** · 2.5 km track to Bhawan (walk ~45–60 min; battery car or pony quicker)	
13:30 – 14:00	HALT	**Bhawan** · Check-in at Bhawan accommodation, deposit belongings in cloak room	
14:00 – 14:45	LUNCH	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Lunch – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pure-veg, pay at counter	
14:45 – 16:30	REST	**Bhawan** · Rest, japa, group kirtan	
16:30 – 18:00	DARSHAN	**Holy Cave, Bhawan** · Queue for darshan of the three Pindis (Mahakali, Mahalakshmi, Mahasaraswati)	
18:00 – 19:30	AARTI	**Bhawan** · Evening Aarti (Atka Aarti passes to be booked in advance)	
19:30 – 20:30	DINNER	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Dinner – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pay at counter; rest after	

Sunday 14 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Ropeway to Bhairon Ghati


Banganga, Katra

DAY 03
Mon 15 Mar

Morning Aarti – Bhairon Temple – Katra

Overnight: **Katra**

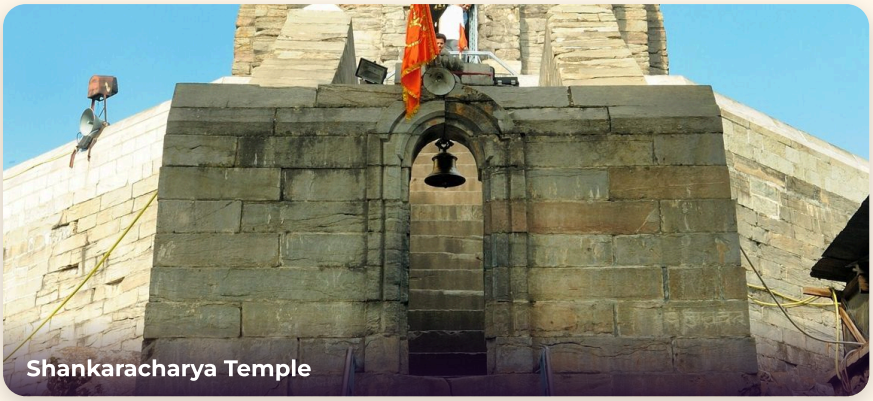
Rise early for the Morning Aarti, then take the ropeway to Bhairon Baba Temple. Walk down to Sanjichhat for the return flight to Katra. After rest, visit Banganga and Darshani Deodi, the traditional gateway of the yatra, and end the day at Katra's market.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

Tradition holds that the yatra is complete only after darshan at Bhairon Baba Temple. At Banganga, the Mother is believed to have shot an arrow into the earth to bring forth water.

04:30 – 05:30	HALT	**Bhawan** · Wake-up, bath, get ready	
05:30 – 07:00	AARTI	**Bhawan** · Morning Aarti at the Holy Cave (fixed temple timing)	
07:00 – 07:30	REST	**Bhawan** · Rest, pack small bag	
07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Breakfast – Shrine Board Bhojanalaya; pay at counter (Bhawan rooms do not include meals)	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Bhawan** · Check-out, collect cloak-room items	
09:00 – 09:15	WALK	**Bhawan → Bhawan ropeway station** · Short walk (~300 m) to lower ropeway station	
09:15 – 09:35	ROPEWAY	**Bhawan ropeway station → Bhairon Ghati** · Ropeway ride ~3 min plus queue (optional; trek 1.5 km otherwise)	
09:35 – 10:15	DARSHAN	**Bhairon Baba Temple** · Darshan of Bhairon Baba – completes the yatra	
10:15 – 11:15	WALK / PONY	**Bhairon Temple → Sanjichhat Helipad** · Downhill track ~3 km via Bhairon–Sanjichhat route	
11:15 – 12:15	REPORTING	**Sanjichhat Helipad** · Report for return slot, ticket & baggage check	
12:15 – 12:25	HELICOPTER	**Sanjichhat Helipad → Katra Helipad** · Return flight approx. 5–8 min	
12:25 – 12:40	CAR	**Katra Helipad → Hotel, Katra** · Pick-up at helipad, drive to hotel	2 km
12:40 – 13:15	HALT	**Hotel, Katra** · Check-in, freshen up	
13:15 – 14:00	LUNCH	**Hotel restaurant / pure-veg restaurant, Katra** · Lunch – at the Katra hotel or a pure-veg restaurant on Main Bazaar; group pays	
14:00 – 16:00	REST	**Hotel, Katra** · Rest	
16:00 – 16:15	CAR	**Hotel, Katra → Banganga** · Drive to Banganga	3 km
16:15 – 17:00	DARSHAN	**Banganga** · Holy river where Mata shot an arrow to bring water; sprinkle / dip, temple darshan	
17:00 – 17:10	CAR	**Banganga → Darshani Deodi** · Short hop	1 km
17:10 – 17:40	DARSHAN	**Darshani Deodi** · Traditional gateway of the yatra; group photo	
17:40 – 17:55	CAR	**Darshani Deodi → Katra Main Bazaar** · Drive to market	2 km
17:55 – 19:30	SHOPPING	**Katra Main Bazaar** · Prasad, chunri, dry fruits, walnut & handicraft shopping	
19:30 – 19:45	CAR / WALK	**Katra Main Bazaar → Hotel, Katra** · Return to hotel, freshen up	1 km
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays; Day 4 briefing	

Monday 15 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Shankaracharya Temple


Dal Lake, Srinagar

DAY 04
Tue 16 Mar

Flight to Srinagar – Shankaracharya – Dal Lake

Overnight: **Srinagar**

After breakfast, drive from Katra to Jammu Airport and fly to Srinagar. After lunch, climb to the hilltop Shankaracharya Temple and take darshan at Jyeshta Devi, then glide across Dal Lake on a shikara with kirtan as the sun sets.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

Shankaracharya Temple, dedicated to Lord Shiva, stands on a hill about 1,000 ft above Srinagar with sweeping views of Dal Lake.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Katra** · Check-out, load luggage	
09:00 – 10:30	CAR	**Hotel, Katra → Jammu Airport** · Drive to Jammu Airport (4-day yatris are dropped here)	50 km
10:30 – 12:00	AIRPORT	**Jammu Airport** · Check-in, security (carry ID; power banks in cabin bag)	
12:00 – 12:50	FLIGHT	**Jammu Airport → Srinagar Airport** · Flight Jammu → Srinagar (book the 11:00–12:00 departure; plan assumes 12:00)	
12:50 – 13:15	AIRPORT	**Srinagar Airport** · Baggage collection, meet Srinagar driver	
13:15 – 14:00	CAR	**Srinagar Airport → Hotel / houseboat, Dal Lake** · Drive to Boulevard Road	14 km
14:00 – 15:00	LUNCH	**Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Lunch – at the hotel / houseboat after check-in; group pays	
15:00 – 15:15	CAR	**Hotel, Dal Lake → Shankaracharya Temple** · Drive up Gopadri hill to the temple parking	5 km
15:15 – 16:00	DARSHAN	**Shankaracharya Temple** · Hilltop Shiva temple, ~240 steps from the parking; views of Dal Lake (phones not allowed – leave in car)	
16:00 – 16:15	CAR	**Shankaracharya Temple → Jyeshta Devi Temple** · Drive to Zethyar	6 km
16:15 – 16:45	DARSHAN	**Jyeshta Devi Temple** · Darshan of Mata Jyeshta Devi	
16:45 – 17:05	CAR	**Jyeshta Devi Temple → Shikara ghat, Dal Lake** · Drive to the shikara ghat on Boulevard Road	6 km
17:05 – 18:30	SHIKARA	**Dal Lake** · Sunset shikara ride past Char Chinari and Nehru Park; kirtan on the boat (floating market runs only at dawn)	
18:30 – 20:00	REST	**Hotel / houseboat, Dal Lake** · Rest; Day 5 briefing (warm clothes, overnight bag for Gulmarg)	
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – hotel on MAP plan (breakfast + dinner included)	

Tuesday 16 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Maharani Temple, Gulmarg


Gulmarg Gondola

DAY 05
Wed 17 Mar

Gulmarg – Gondola & Maharani Temple

Overnight: **Gulmarg**

It is Amalaki Ekadashi: we fast from grains together and honour the day with kirtan. Drive to Gulmarg, the Meadow of Flowers, ride the gondola towards Apharwat for snow views, then take darshan at the hilltop Maharani Shiva temple and watch the sunset over the meadow.

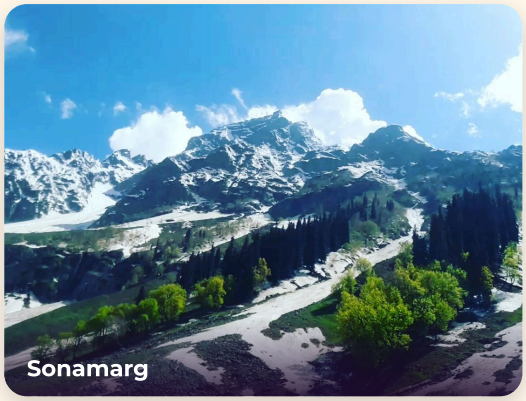
DID YOU KNOW?

The Gulmarg Gondola is among the highest cable cars in the world; its second phase climbs to about 4,000 m on Apharwat.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP); Amalaki Ekadashi – grain-free items	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Srinagar** · Check-out (main luggage can stay at the Srinagar hotel for Day 6 return)	
09:00 – 10:45	CAR	**Hotel, Srinagar → Gulmarg** · Drive via Tangmarg (hire snow boots / coats at Tangmarg)	50 km
10:45 – 13:45	GONDOLA	**Gulmarg Gondola: Kongdori (Phase 1) and Apharwat (Phase 2)** · Gondola ride (optional; book tickets online in advance); Snow Point and Apharwat Peak views	
13:45 – 14:30	LUNCH	**Pure-veg restaurant, Gulmarg** · Lunch – Amalaki Ekadashi: grain-free Ekadashi prasadam (fruits, potato, sabudana), pre-ordered; group pays	
14:30 – 15:00	HALT	**Hotel, Gulmarg** · Check-in	
15:00 – 15:15	CAR	**Hotel, Gulmarg → Maharani Temple** · Short drive / walk across the meadow	2 km
15:15 – 16:00	DARSHAN	**Maharani Temple (Shiva temple), Gulmarg** · Darshan at the hilltop Shiva temple in the Gulmarg meadow	
16:00 – 17:30	SIGHTSEEING	**Gulmarg meadow viewpoints** · Meadow walk, Himalayan views at sunset, group photo	
17:30 – 20:00	REST	**Hotel, Gulmarg** · Rest, Ekadashi kirtan; Day 6 briefing (long drive)	
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Dinner – included (MAP); Ekadashi grain-free menu pre-ordered with the hotel	

Wednesday 17 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Kheer Bhawani, Tulmulla


Sonamarg

DAY 06
Thu 18 Mar

Kheer Bhawani – Sonamarg – Srinagar

Overnight: **Srinagar**

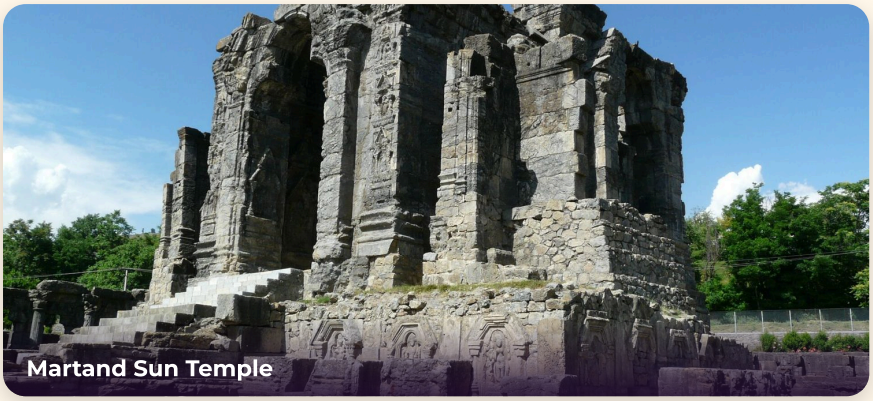
Break the Ekadashi fast at the 7:30 am breakfast, then leave at 9 am for Kheer Bhawani in Tulmulla for darshan of Mata Ragnya Devi. Continue along the Sindh river to Sonamarg, the Meadow of Gold, for Thajiwas Glacier and the snow, and return to Srinagar in the evening.

SACRED SIGNIFICANCE

At Kheer Bhawani the Mother is worshipped as Ragnya Devi in a sacred spring; devotees offer kheer, and the spring's changing colour is regarded as a sign by the faithful.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Break fast (parana) 07:14–10:26 – breakfast included (MAP)	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Gulmarg** · Check-out, load luggage	
09:00 – 11:00	CAR	**Gulmarg → Kheer Bhawani Temple, Tulmulla** · Drive via Tangmarg and Ganderbal	70 km
11:00 – 11:45	DARSHAN	**Kheer Bhawani Temple** · Darshan of Mata Ragnya Devi at the sacred spring; kheer offering	
11:45 – 13:45	CAR	**Tulmulla → Sonamarg** · Scenic drive along the Sindh river	60 km
13:45 – 14:30	LUNCH	**Pure-veg restaurant, Sonamarg** · Lunch – pure-veg dhaba / restaurant at Sonamarg market; group pays	
14:30 – 15:45	PONY / LOCAL TAXI	**Sonamarg → Thajiwas Glacier** · Thajiwas Glacier by pony (optional, ~3 km; fixed union rates); snow play	
15:45 – 16:15	SIGHTSEEING	**Sindh River viewpoints, Sonamarg** · Sindh river banks and snow-peak viewpoints; group photo	
16:15 – 19:15	CAR	**Sonamarg → Hotel, Srinagar** · Return to Srinagar (last hour after dark – experienced driver)	82 km
19:15 – 20:00	REST	**Hotel, Srinagar** · Check-in, freshen up	
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – included (MAP)	

Thursday 18 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Martand Sun Temple


Betaab Valley

DAY 07
Fri 19 Mar

Avantipur – Martand – Pahalgam

Overnight: **Pahalgam**

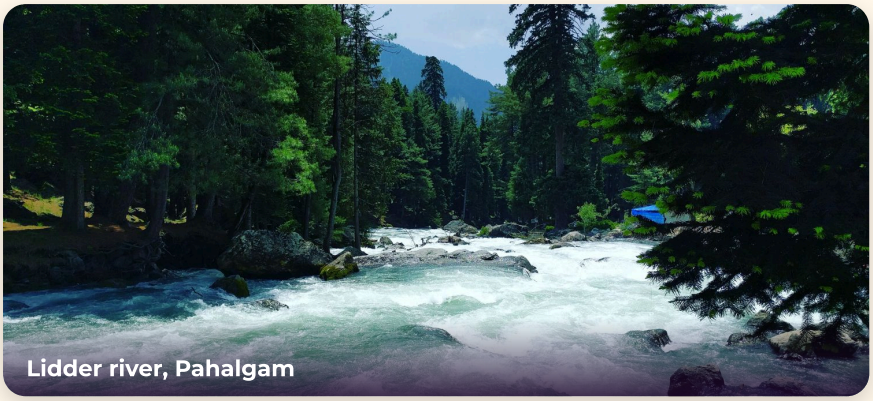
On the way to Pahalgam visit the 9th-century Avantipur temple ruins and the 8th-century Martand Sun Temple. In the afternoon, local cabs take you towards Chandanwari, Betaab Valley and Aru Valley, ending with an evening walk by the Lidder river.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Martand Sun Temple was built by King Lalitaditya Muktapida in the 8th century and is one of the finest examples of Kashmiri temple architecture.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP)	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Srinagar** · Check-out, load luggage	
09:00 – 10:00	CAR	**Hotel, Srinagar → Avantipur Temple Ruins** · Drive on the Jammu–Srinagar highway	30 km
10:00 – 10:45	SIGHTSEEING	**Avantipur Temple Ruins** · 9th-century Avantiswami (Vishnu) temple ruins	
10:45 – 11:45	CAR	**Avantipur → Martand Sun Temple** · Via Anantnag	35 km
11:45 – 12:30	SIGHTSEEING	**Martand Sun Temple** · 8th-century Surya temple ruins on the Mattan plateau	
12:30 – 13:45	CAR	**Martand → Hotel, Pahalgam** · Drive along the Lidder river	40 km
13:45 – 14:00	HALT	**Hotel, Pahalgam** · Check-in	
14:00 – 14:45	LUNCH	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Lunch – at the Pahalgam hotel; group pays	
14:45 – 15:00	HALT	**Pahalgam taxi stand** · Board local union cabs (our car cannot go beyond Pahalgam)	
15:00 – 15:40	UNION CAB	**Pahalgam → Chandanwari** · 16 km by union cab (if open in March)	
15:40 – 16:10	SIGHTSEEING	**Chandanwari** · Start point of the Amarnath route; snow	
16:10 – 16:30	UNION CAB	**Chandanwari → Betaab Valley** · 7 km	
16:30 – 17:05	SIGHTSEEING	**Betaab Valley** · Meadows and river, photo stop (entry ticket)	
17:05 – 17:55	UNION CAB	**Betaab Valley → Aru Valley** · 21 km via Pahalgam	
17:55 – 18:25	SIGHTSEEING	**Aru Valley** · Meadow village, pine forests, sunset	
18:25 – 18:55	UNION CAB	**Aru Valley → Hotel, Pahalgam** · 12 km back to Pahalgam	
19:00 – 19:30	WALK	**Lidder River banks** · Short evening walk by the Lidder river; kirtan	
20:00 – 21:00	DINNER	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Dinner – included (MAP)	

Friday 19 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.


Lidder river, Pahalgam


Aru Valley

DAY 08
Sat 20 Mar

Pahalgam – Pampore – Departure

Departure · **Jai Mata Di!**

After breakfast, leave Pahalgam at 9 am and drive through the Jhelum valley to Pampore, famous for its saffron fields, for saffron and dry-fruit shopping. Reach Srinagar Airport by 11:45 with a packed lunch, for flights after 2 pm, carrying the blessings of Mata Vaishno Devi and Lord Shiva.

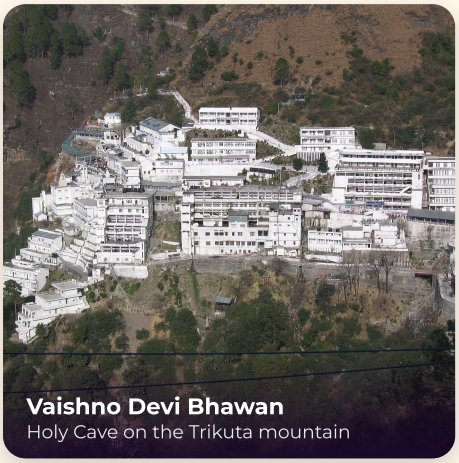
DID YOU KNOW?

Pampore, near Srinagar, is known as the saffron town of Kashmir; its saffron fields bloom in autumn.

07:30 – 08:30	BREAKFAST	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Breakfast – included (MAP)	
08:30 – 09:00	HALT	**Hotel, Pahalgam** · Check-out, load luggage; collect packed lunch	
09:00 – 10:45	CAR	**Pahalgam → Pampore** · Drive towards Srinagar along the Jhelum valley	80 km
10:45 – 11:15	SHOPPING	**Pampore saffron and dry-fruit shops** · Saffron, walnuts, almonds and dry fruits from government-approved shops	
11:15 – 11:45	CAR	**Pampore → Srinagar Airport** · Drive to the airport (allow for security checkpoints)	20 km
11:45 – 12:15	LUNCH	**Packed lunch at Srinagar Airport** · Packed lunch from the Pahalgam hotel, eaten before security; group pays	
12:15 – 12:30	DEPARTURE	**Srinagar Airport** · Farewell, Jai Mata Di! Har Har Mahadev! (departure flights after 14:00; Srinagar security takes time)	

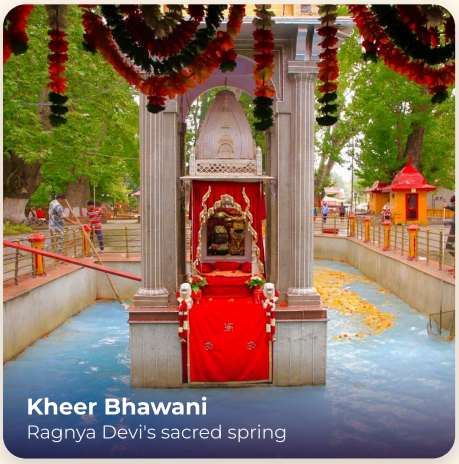
Saturday 20 March 2027 · Timings are indicative and may change with flight slots, weather and darshan queues. Distances by road are approximate.

Sacred places *on this yatra*


Vaishno Devi Bhawan
Holy Cave on the Trikuta mountain


Sanjichhat Helipad
Helicopter landing near Bhawan

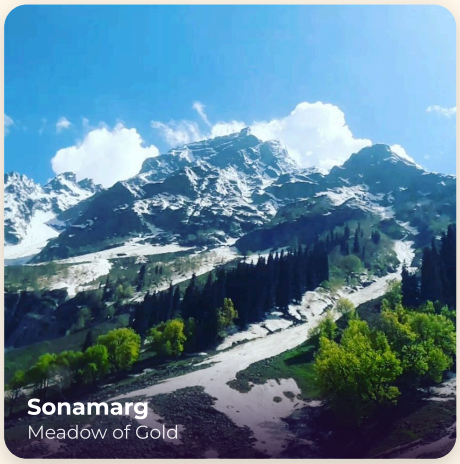

Bahu Fort, Jammu
Home of Bawe Wali Mata


Kheer Bhawani
Ragnya Devi's sacred spring


Shankaracharya Temple
Hilltop Shiva temple, Srinagar


Martand Sun Temple
8th-century Surya temple


Maharani Temple, Gulmarg
Shiva temple in the meadow


Sonamarg
Meadow of Gold


Dal Lake
Shikara at sunset

PACKAGE INCLUDES

- Accommodation: Jammu (1 night), Bhawan (1 night), Katra (1 night) with breakfast; Srinagar hotel / houseboat (2 nights), Gulmarg (1 night), Pahalgam (1 night) with breakfast & dinner
- Helicopter tickets Katra ⇄ Sanjichhat and Bhairon ropeway
- Flight Jammu → Srinagar
- All transfers and sightseeing by private vehicle (about 643 km)
- Union cabs at Pahalgam; Dal Lake shikara ride
- Pure-vegetarian meals as per the meal plan, including Ekadashi prasadam
- Atka Aarti passes (subject to Shrine Board availability); monument entry tickets
- Tour leader and escort; daily kirtan and sthala purana
- Travel insurance

NOT INCLUDED

- Air or train fare to Jammu and from Srinagar (can be arranged)
- Day 1 breakfast (on own while travelling)
- Gulmarg gondola tickets (optional, booked on request)
- Pony at Sonamarg; pony / palki at Vaishno Devi (paid on actuals)
- Personal offerings, shopping, tips and porterage
- GST as applicable

PACKAGE PRICE & DATES

Saturday 13 – Saturday 20 March 2027

Price on request · limited seats (helicopter quota).
Registrations close 25 December 2026.
Call **95053 88886** for the latest price and seats.

FLIGHT INFO · PLEASE BOOK ACCORDINGLY

- Arrive Jammu Airport: Sat 13 Mar 2027, before 2 pm
- Jammu → Srinagar: Tue 16 Mar 2027, 11 am – 12 noon
- Depart Srinagar Airport: Sat 20 Mar 2027, after 2 pm

Every meal *planned with care*

Breakfast and dinner in Kashmir are included with the hotel (MAP plan); Bhawan meals are at the Shrine Board Bhojanalaya; lunches are pre-booked at hotels and pure-veg restaurants. No onion-garlic food on request.

Day 1	BREAKFAST	08:00–08:30	**On own – at home / origin airport / in flight** · Breakfast on own before or during travel to Jammu (not included); carry a light snack, lunch is at 15:15
Day 1	LUNCH	15:15–15:50	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Late lunch – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg thali served on arrival; group pays
Day 1	DINNER	20:15–21:15	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays (not in room rate)
Day 2	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Jammu** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay
Day 2	LUNCH	14:00–14:45	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Lunch – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pure-veg, pay at counter
Day 2	DINNER	19:30–20:30	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Dinner – Shrine Board (SMVDSB) Bhojanalaya; pay at counter; rest after
Day 3	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Shrine Board Bhojanalaya, Bhawan** · Breakfast – Shrine Board Bhojanalaya; pay at counter (Bhawan rooms do not include meals)
Day 3	LUNCH	13:15–14:00	**Hotel restaurant / pure-veg restaurant, Katra** · Lunch – at the Katra hotel or a pure-veg restaurant on Main Bazaar; group pays
Day 3	DINNER	20:00–21:00	**Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Dinner – at the hotel, pre-ordered pure-veg menu; group pays; Day 4 briefing
Day 4	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Katra** · Breakfast – complimentary with the hotel stay
Day 4	LUNCH	14:00–15:00	**Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Lunch – at the hotel / houseboat after check-in; group pays
Day 4	DINNER	20:00–21:00	**Hotel / houseboat restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – hotel on MAP plan (breakfast + dinner included)
Day 5	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP); Amalaki Ekadashi – grain-free items
Day 5	LUNCH	13:45–14:30	**Pure-veg restaurant, Gulmarg** · Lunch – Amalaki Ekadashi: grain-free Ekadashi prasadam (fruits, potato, sabudana), pre-ordered; group pays
Day 5	DINNER	20:00–21:00	**Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Dinner – included (MAP); Ekadashi grain-free menu pre-ordered with the hotel
Day 6	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Gulmarg** · Break fast (parana) 07:14–10:26 – breakfast included (MAP)
Day 6	LUNCH	13:45–14:30	**Pure-veg restaurant, Sonamarg** · Lunch – pure-veg dhaba / restaurant at Sonamarg market; group pays
Day 6	DINNER	20:00–21:00	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Dinner – included (MAP)
Day 7	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Srinagar** · Breakfast – included (MAP)
Day 7	LUNCH	14:00–14:45	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Lunch – at the Pahalgam hotel; group pays
Day 7	DINNER	20:00–21:00	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Dinner – included (MAP)
Day 8	BREAKFAST	07:30–08:30	**Hotel restaurant, Pahalgam** · Breakfast – included (MAP)
Day 8	LUNCH	11:45–12:15	**Packed lunch at Srinagar Airport** · Packed lunch from the Pahalgam hotel, eaten before security; group pays

How we are *different*

1 Sattvic food
Pure-vegetarian meals planned for every day; no onion-garlic on request

2 Pre-approved stays
Hotels checked and approved by Punya Kshetras, not booked blind

3 Comfortable transport
Clean, well-kept vehicles with experienced hill drivers

4 Care for seniors
Escorts on the track, pony / palki arranged in advance, unhurried pace

5 Narration by devotees
Sthala purana and the glories of each holy place, in Telugu, Hindi and English

6 Family-like yatra
Kirtan, japa and satsang every day with ISKCON Hare Krishna devotees

7 No hidden charges
No service or booking charges; one clear package price

CURATED SPECIAL EXPERIENCES

- Melodious bhajans & kirtans
- Sthala purana narrations
- Comfortable stay
- Relaxed itinerary
- Special care for seniors
- Sattvic food



Moments from our past yatras


Devotees on yatra with Punya Kshetras

PACK THESE

- Original photo ID + copy
- Thermals, warm jacket, cap, gloves
- Small day bag for Bhawan
- Walking shoes with grip
- Sunglasses for snow glare
- Personal medicines
- Postpaid SIM, power bank

DO'S

- Carry original photo ID at all times
- Keep the RFID Yatra card with you from Katra
- Report 10 minutes before every departure
- Stay with your buddy; wear the group scarf
- Use cloak rooms before darshan
- Dress in warm layers in Kashmir

DON'TS

- No phones, cameras or leather goods in darshan areas
- No extra baggage on the helicopter
- Don't rely on prepaid SIMs from outside J&K
- Don't buy prasad from touts
- Don't wear new shoes
- Don't photograph security forces

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Who can join?

Anyone in reasonable health. Seniors are welcome; we pre-arrange pony, palki or battery car for those who cannot walk the 2.5 km track.

What ID do I need?

Original Aadhaar or passport for every yatri, including for the RFID Yatra card at Katra and for flights.

Will my phone work?

Prepaid SIMs from outside Jammu & Kashmir do not work there. Carry a postpaid connection; our team carries postpaid phones.

What food is served?

Pure-vegetarian meals throughout; no onion-garlic food on request at hotels.

Is Kashmir safe for pilgrims?

We travel with a registered local partner and follow daily advisories from the hotel and authorities; the plan is adjusted if any area is closed.

How cold will it be in March?

Days are cool and nights near or below freezing in Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam. Pack thermals, a warm jacket, cap and gloves; snow boots can be hired at Tangmarg.

BOOKING & PAYMENT

Seats are confirmed only after the advance is received. Full and final payment is due before departure; yatris cannot join the tour otherwise. We accept bank transfer, UPI, cheque and cash; card payments carry 2% extra.

CANCELLATION BY YATRI

Requests must be sent in writing to connect@hkmhyderabad.org. More than 45 days before travel: 30% of tour cost retained, 70% refunded. 45 to 30 days: 50% retained. Less than 30 days, no-show, or after the tour starts: no refund. Refunds are paid after 30 days of cancellation.

RESCHEDULING

Allowed once, subject to availability, on payment of 10% of the tour cost, if requested at least 7 days before travel. Later requests are treated as a cancellation.

HELICOPTER & WEATHER

Helicopter services to Sanjichhat are run under Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board rules and depend on weather. If a flight is cancelled or delayed, our team will arrange the best alternative (next slot, pony, palki or the track). Extra stay, food or transport caused by weather, technical reasons or government orders is borne by the yatris.

BAGGAGE

Only a small hand bag is allowed on the helicopter; the main luggage waits in the vehicle or hotel. Yatris must declare their correct weight at booking.

MEDICAL

Please tell us about any medical condition or special need at the time of booking. Consult your doctor before the yatra. Punya Kshetras is not liable for medical emergencies; evacuation costs are borne by the yatri.

GOVERNMENT LEVIES

Any increase in taxes, temple or government charges after booking is payable by the yatris before departure.

CONDUCT

We may cancel the participation of any yatri who is unruly, intoxicated or unsafe to travel, without refund.

CANCELLATION BY US

If we cancel the yatra, the amount paid is refunded in full; no compensation is payable for consequential loss.

DISPUTES

Subject to the jurisdiction of courts in Hyderabad, Telangana. Booking implies acceptance of these terms.

WHO JOINED OUR YATRAS



HARE KRISHNA GOLDEN TEMPLE
BANJARA HILLS

PUNYA KSHETRAS
NOURISH YOUR SOUL ON SACRED JOURNEYS

Pilgrimage is reconnection with God

For details & registration

Please contact any temple devotee you are in touch with, or

95053 88886

✉ booking@punyakshetras.com

www.punyakshetras.com · www.hkmhyderabad.org

Facebook · Instagram · YouTube · X: @punyakshetras · HareKrishnaGoldenTemple

Swayambhu Sri Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Kshetram, Road #12, near Anti Corruption Bureau office, NBT Nagar, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad, Telangana 500034

Jai Mata Di! Har Har Mahadev!

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